

THE TWO ADAMS

Two Humanities, Two Allegiances, Two Destinies

Adam seized dominion and led humanity into rebellion and death. Christ fulfilled the human vocation and leads a new humanity into life.



BIG IDEA

The Bible tells the human story through two men: Adam begins the old humanity; Christ begins the new.

KEY SCRIPTURE

Romans 5:12-21

ALSO READ

1 Corinthians 15:20-28

MEMORY VERSE

1 CORINTHIANS 15:22

"For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive."

MAIN QUESTION

Why Can Jesus Lead Humanity Where Adam Could Not?

45 MINUTES

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SESSION SNAPSHOT



A

OPENING ACTIVITY: "TRACE THE TWO LINES"

1

DRAW TWO HEADINGS (2 MIN)

Write ADAM on the left and CHRIST on the right. Ask students what they remember about Adam's received calling and rebellion.

2

ADD FOUR CONTRASTS (2 MIN)

Invite students to predict the contrasts: seized / received; self-rule / obedience; death / life; old humanity / new humanity.

3

ASK ABOUT LEADERSHIP (2 MIN)

Say: These are not merely two private lives. Each man stands at the beginning of a humanity that shares his order and destiny.

4

OPEN THE TEXTS (2 MIN)

Read Romans 5:12 and 1 Corinthians 15:20-22. Ask students to listen for two men, two reigning powers, and two outcomes.

SESSION GOALS

Students should leave understanding:

- Adam received life, image-bearing, and dominion but seized self-rule.
- Humanity is born into Adam's world and personally confirms his rebellion.
- Christ lived in obedient dependence and fulfilled the human vocation.
- Christ rose into incorruptible human life beyond death's dominion.
- Salvation means deliverance from Adam's humanity and entrance into Christ's.



LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not teach that Adam's private guilt is mechanically transferred. Adam established the old humanity's order; every accountable person personally confirms it. Christ alone does not.



PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Two colored markers
- Student handouts
- Review Sessions 2-3

The last Adam does not repair Adam's humanity. He begins another humanity in Himself.

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B CORE TEACHING

1 ADAM RECEIVED AND SEIZED Gen. 1:26-28

Adam received life, image-bearing vocation, and dominion from God. In rebellion, he tried to possess wisdom and rule independently of the One who gave them.

EMPHASIZE: Adam's dominion was entrusted; his self-rule was seized.

2 ADAM BEGINS THE OLD HUMANITY Rom. 5:12-21

Adam's rebellion established a human order of alienation, corruption, and death. Each accountable descendant personally joins that order through his own self-rule.

EMPHASIZE: We inherit Adam's world and confirm Adam's choice.

3 CHRIST FULFILLS THE VOCATION Phil. 2:5-11

The eternal Son truly became human, lived in filial dependence, obeyed where Adam rebelled, and fulfilled every responsibility humanity abandoned - even unto death.

EMPHASIZE: Where Adam grasped, Christ received and obeyed.

4 CHRIST BEGINS THE NEW HUMANITY 1 Cor. 15:20-49

Christ rose into incorruptible human life over which death has no dominion. As the last Adam, He becomes the life-giving head of all who are joined to Him.

EMPHASIZE: Those who belong to Christ share His life and future.

2 TWO HUMANITIES

IN ADAM

- Self-rule
- Death reigns
- Old humanity
- Inevitable death

IN CHRIST

- Obedient dependence
- Grace reigns
- New humanity
- Resurrection life

? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1 What did Adam receive, and what did he try to seize?

Follow-up: Why is that difference central to sin?

2 How is Adam more than a bad example?

Follow-up: What kind of world and humanity did he establish?

3 How does Philippians 2 contrast Christ with Adam's pattern?

Follow-up: Where do you see dependence and obedience?

4 What new reality begins with Christ's resurrection?

Follow-up: Why is He more than Adam repaired?

5 Why is salvation a change of humanity, not merely behavior?

Follow-up: What would it mean to belong to Christ?

! WEEKLY REFLECTION

Listen for the two voices in ordinary choices: Adam's self-rule and Christ's obedient dependence.

- Am I grasping for control or receiving God's Word?
- Which humanity's pattern am I displaying?
- What would surrender to Christ look like here?

+ PRIVATE CONVERSATION

The question is not only whether you admire Christ. Do you belong to Him? If you are unsure, ask a leader to open the Bible with you privately.

N LEADER NOTES

- Keep two humanities central.
- Do not teach universal salvation.
- Distinguish Adamic birth from saving union.
- Christ is seated, awaiting public reign.
- Point toward personal belonging.